01 / EXAM OVERVIEW

What is CAE?

C1 Advanced

Formerly called the Certificate in Advanced English (CAE). It shows you can use English at an advanced level for study and work.

What C1 involves

At C1, you can understand demanding texts, express ideas fluently and adapt your English to different situations.

BEFORE YOU BOOK

The exam is available in digital and paper-based formats. Check which dates and formats your local exam centre offers.

LEVEL & FORMATS

05 / RESULTS & NEXT STEPS

Your score

The overall score averages five Cambridge English Scale scores: Reading, Use of English, Writing, Listening and Speaking.

SCORE	RESULT	CEFR
200–210	Grade A	C2
193–199	Grade B	C1
180–192	Grade C	C1
160–179	Level B2	B2

Scores of 142–159 appear on the Statement of Results only. A certificate starts at 160 (B2) and a C1 result at 180.

OFFICIAL CAMBRIDGE RESOURCES

Exam format

Results and grading

Free sample papers and practice

cambridgeenglish.org

SCORES & PREPARATION

EXAM CANDIDATE'S GUIDE

C1 Advanced

Cambridge English

CAE

Find out what happens in each paper and what your Cambridge English Scale score means.

R **Reading & Use of English**

W **Writing**

L **Listening**

S **Speaking**

Four papers · About 4 hours

CAMBRIDGE ENGLISH QUALIFICATIONS

02 / PAPER 1

Reading & Use of English

90 MIN / 8 PARTS / 56 QUESTIONS

Read varied texts and show your control of grammar and vocabulary.

1. **Multiple-choice cloze** Choose the best word or phrase for each gap.
2. **Open cloze** Supply one word for each gap.
3. **Word formation** Change a given word to fit the gap.
4. **Key word transformations** Keep the same meaning and use the key word.
5. **Multiple choice** Answer questions about a text.
6. **Cross-text matching** Compare opinions across four short texts.
7. **Gapped text** Put missing paragraphs back into a text.
8. **Multiple matching** Find which text or section contains the information.

READING, GRAMMAR & VOCABULARY

03 / PAPER 2

Writing

90 MIN / 2 TEXTS

Write 220–260 words for each part. Both pieces of writing carry equal weight.

PART 1 / COMPULSORY ESSAY

Discuss two of the points provided. Explain which is more important and give reasons for your choice.

Example Compare better cycle lanes and lower fares as ways to cut traffic. Which would help more?

PART 2 / CHOOSE ONE TASK

Choose one of three tasks. Write a letter or email, proposal, report or review. Adapt your tone to the reader and purpose.

Example Write a proposal for your college to make better use of an empty classroom.

ESSAY & CHOICE OF TASK

04 / PAPERS 3 & 4

Listen & speak

Listening

≈40 MIN / 4 PARTS / 30 QUESTIONS

You hear each recording twice. Tasks include multiple choice, sentence completion and two matching tasks on the same five speakers.

Speaking

15 MIN PER PAIR / 4 PARTS

Usually taken with another candidate and two examiners.

1. **Interview** Answer questions about yourself.
2. **Photo comparison** Compare two of three photos for one minute. Respond briefly after your partner’s turn.
3. **Joint task** Discuss options with your partner and try to reach a decision.
4. **Discussion** Answer broader questions linked to the joint task.

LISTENING & SPEAKING